Peak 11 Media

Hiring & Delegation Plan

How to lift the owner out of the daily grind and run the web-design business as a near-passive, revenue-funded operation. Updated June 2026.

0. The Goal of This Document

Peak 11 already runs almost entirely on AI. Lead generation, site building, edits, deploys, demo videos, and the entire back office are handled by Claude — at near-zero marginal cost and with full SOPs already written. There is exactly **one task that still requires a live human voice**: the sales call. That single bottleneck is what keeps the owner (Nate) in the daily grind.

This plan removes that bottleneck. It hires, in order, the two roles that take the owner out of the loop — a **commission closer** (removes the calling) and a **VA / ops assistant** (removes the admin) — and lays out the org evolution so the business can run nearly hands-off. The governing rule: **every hire is funded by revenue the business has already proven, never ahead of it.**

The one principle that runs through everything below

Humans do the two things AI can't: talk to a person on the phone and hold a relationship. Everything else — building sites, edits, deploys, lead-gen, CRM automation, receipts — stays with Claude/AI at near-zero cost. We only ever hire to buy back the owner's voice and time, and we only hire when the revenue to pay that person already exists.

The Business in One Table (what a new hire steps into)

Element	Current state
Offer ladder	Starter \$900 · Standard \$1,200 · Care Plan \$49/mo (recurring)
Pipeline	100+ verified, scored leads (Wasatch Front), sorted Priority 5→1; call-ready
Sales assets	Call sheet, personalized scripts, objection lines, live demo sites + walkthrough videos
Fulfillment	AI-built custom sites in 5–10 min; edits, deploys, hosting all automated (Claude)
Back office	Stripe links + receipts, signed-contract flow, CRM tracker — all SOP'd
The one human task	The voice sales call (and ongoing client relationship)

A new closer is handed a loaded gun: verified leads, proven demos, and a tested script. They are not asked to generate anything — only to close.

1. The Commission Closer

Removes the owner from the phones. This is the single highest-leverage hire in the entire business.

1.1 Role Definition

A commission-only remote phone closer. They call the pre-verified leads, run the proven pitch, send the demo, handle objections, and close the build at $900–$1,200. They do **not** source leads, do **not** build sites, do **not** do admin. Their entire job is: dial → pitch → send link to the live demo → handle objections → get a yes → hand the closed deal back to the system. One sentence: **they convert a warm, verified lead list into signed contracts over the phone.**

- **Owns:** outbound calls, follow-ups, objection handling, getting the verbal yes and the contract e-signed.
- **Does NOT own:** finding leads (AI), building/editing the site (AI), payments/receipts (automated), client management after the sale (owner + AI).
- **Reports:** logs every call outcome in the CRM (the VA or Claude keeps it clean). Daily target early on: 15–30 dials from the Priority-sorted sheet.

1.2 Where to Find Them

Source	Why it works / how to use it
Commission-only sales communities	Closers love commission-only remote gigs. Post in: CloserCash, Remote Closing Academy alumni groups, Sale
Upwork	Filter for "appointment setter / B2B phone sales / cold caller," U.S.-based, with reviews. Post a fixed-scope test
OnlineJobs.ph	Filipino closers with strong, neutral-accent English exist and are far cheaper. Best for the *setter* half if you split
r/sales and r/msp	Post a clear commission-only listing. r/sales has experienced closers between roles; r/msp and local web/marke
Local (SLC / Wasatch Front)	A local closer who knows Utah small businesses and speaks the same small-town language converts best. Sou

1.3 Compensation Structure

Commission-only, so the role costs **$0 until it produces revenue** — perfectly aligned with the prime principle. Pay per closed build, plus a slice of the first month of recurring Care Plan revenue to incentivize closing the full package.

Deal	Ticket	Closer commission	Closer gets	Peak 11 keeps
Starter build	$900	15%	$135	$765
Standard build	$1,200	15%	$180	$1,020
Aggressive (ramp/top closer)	$900–$1,200	20%	$180–$240	$720–$960
Care Plan bonus	$49/mo	1st month only	$49	recurring kept after

- **Start at 15%** of the build ticket ($135–$180/deal). Go to **20%** for a proven closer or to win a strong candidate — even at 20% Peak 11 keeps $720–$960 per deal on near-zero fulfillment cost.
- **Care-plan slice:** give the closer the **entire first month's $49** Care Plan fee as a bonus for closing the build WITH the plan attached. Peak 11 keeps every recurring month after — this trains closers to always attach the MRR.
- **Paid on collected cash, not verbal yes.** Commission is earned when the client's payment clears Stripe (or at minimum the deposit), never on a promise. This is stated up front and removes disputes.

- **No base, no draw** to start. If a standout closer needs a small base to commit, only offer it once they've proven closes — and recover it against commission.

Why commission-only is the right call here

Fulfillment is AI and costs almost nothing, so Peak 11 can afford to give the closer a fat 15–20% and still bank $765–$1,020 per deal. Commission-only means a closer who doesn't perform costs nothing, and a closer who crushes it is paying for themselves many times over. The interests are perfectly aligned: they only make money when Peak 11 makes more.

1.4 What They're Handed (the loaded gun)

The closer generates nothing from scratch. On day one they receive a complete kit — every piece already exists:

- **The leads** — 100+ verified, scored businesses, sorted Priority 5→1, with phone, owner name, website status, and the exact reason they need a site (Lead-Gen SOP output).
- **The scripts** — the full Sales Scripts PDF: opener by website-status, value framing, objection lines, and the close. They read a tested script, not improvise.
- **The live demos** — each priority lead has a real, personalized demo site already live (and a 45-second walkthrough video) to text/email mid-call. "I already built you a preview — want to see it?" is the strongest line in the pitch.
- **The CRM** — a shared tracker where they log every dial, callback, and close. The VA/Claude keeps it clean; the closer just updates outcomes.
- **The offer + payment flow** — fixed pricing ($900/$1,200 + $49/mo), the contract, and the Stripe link flow are all automated. The closer never quotes custom or touches money — they get the yes and the system sends the contract and link.

The closer's job is intentionally narrow

Everything that could be systematized already has been. The closer is not a marketer, a builder, or an account manager — they are a specialist whose only job is turning a warm, verified lead into a signed deal on the phone. Narrow role = easy to hire, easy to train, easy to replace, easy to scale to two.

1.5 Onboarding & Training (straight from the playbooks)

Onboarding is a half-day because the entire system is already documented. The playbooks ARE the training program:

Step	What they do	Source
1. Read the pitch	Absorb the offer, pricing, and why local businesses buy	Operations Playbook + Sales Scripts
2. Learn the scripts	Openers by website-status, objections, the close	Peak 11 Sales Scripts PDF
3. See the product	Walk the live demo sites + watch the walkthrough videos	demo-urls.md / demo-videos
4. Learn the CRM	How to log calls, set callbacks, mark a close	CRM tracker + Lead-Gen SOP
5. Learn the handoff	What happens after “yes” (contract → Stripe link → build)	Payments SOP + Go-Live SOP
6. Mock call	Run the script against the owner/Claude before going live	Screening test (§1.6)

After step 6, they start at the top of the Priority-5 list — the hottest, clearest-pitch leads — so early calls are the easiest wins and build momentum.

1.6 How to Screen (the mock-call test)

Do not hire on a résumé. Hire on a **10-minute mock call**. This single test filters out 90% of bad fits:

- **Setup:** Give the candidate one demo lead (e.g. a no-website auto shop) and the opener line. Tell them: “I'm the shop owner. Sell me a website.” The owner or Claude plays the owner.
- **Throw 3 stock objections:** (1) “I'm too busy / not interested,” (2) “I already have a Facebook page, that's enough,” (3) “$900 is too much.” The Sales Scripts PDF has the model answers — you're checking if they can hold the line and reframe, not whether they memorized it.

- **Score on 4 things:** tone & warmth (do you trust this voice?), did they actually ask for the sale, did they handle objections without folding, and did they use the demo as the hook.
- **Green light:** confident, conversational, didn't crumble on price, naturally pivoted to “let me show you the preview I built.” **Red flag:** robotic script-reading, apologizing for the price, talking past the buyer, no clear ask for the close.

Run a paid trial before any commitment

After a passing mock call, give the new closer a small batch of 20–30 live leads on pure commission. No salary, no risk. If they close even 2–3, they've paid for themselves and proven the role — keep them and feed them more leads. If they close zero with good leads and a proven script, the script works and the closer doesn't: move on. The trial costs nothing because it's commission-only.

1.7 When to Hire (timing gate)

Do not hire the closer first. **The owner must prove the close himself** on the first handful of deals. This isn't a delay for its own sake — it's what makes the hire safe and trainable:

- **The trigger:** after the owner personally closes roughly the **first 3–5 deals** from the call sheet. (4–5 closes also happens to clear the first $5k month — see Payments SOP.)
- **Why wait:** closing it himself proves the offer converts, sharpens the actual winning script, and produces real call recordings/notes to train the closer with. You can't teach a close you've never made.
- **What it unlocks:** once proven, the owner is handing off a **known-good, repeatable** process — not gambling on an unproven pitch with someone else's mouth. That's the whole point: the owner exits the phones only after the phones are proven to work.

1.8 Ramp Expectations & Scaling 1 → 2 Closers

Phase	Setup	Realistic monthly closes	Build revenue (avg ~$1,050)	Owner on phones?
Prove-it	Owner closes	3–5 (first deals)	~$3k–$5k	Yes — temporary
1 closer	Closer on commission	6–10 / mo as they ramp	~$6k–$10k	No
2 closers	Add a 2nd proven closer	12–20+ / mo combined	~$13k–$21k	No

- **Ramp curve:** a new closer is slow week 1 (learning), then climbs. Expect a real close rate to settle around 1 in 8–12 reached owners on a warm, verified list — they're not cold-prospecting, the leads are pre-qualified.
- **1 → 2 closers:** add the second closer once the first is consistently closing AND the lead pipeline can feed two people (the AI lead-gen scales infinitely, so the real gate is closer #1's proven performance, not lead supply).
- **Why 2 doesn't just double cost:** closers are commission-only — a second closer adds revenue and only costs money when they produce it. Two closers × ~8 closes each ≈ 16 builds/mo ≈ ~$17k builds + a stack of new $49 Care Plans every month.
- **The owner's role shrinks to oversight** — reviewing closer performance, occasionally jumping on a whale deal, and approving edge cases. The phones are no longer his.

2. The VA / Ops Assistant

Removes the admin. The second hire — it keeps the machine clean so the closer only closes and the owner only oversees.

2.1 Role Definition

A part-time-to-full-time virtual assistant who runs the operational housekeeping that AI doesn't need a human for but that benefits from a consistent human owner: keeping the lead pipeline topped up and verified, the CRM clean, the calendar booked, client edit-requests triaged, and reviews/referrals chased. They follow the SOPs we already wrote — they execute a documented process, they don't invent one.

2.2 Where to Hire

Source	Cost	Best for
OnlineJobs.ph	~$400–$800 / mo full-time	The primary pick. Full-time Filipino VA, strong English, great work ethic, huge talent pool
Upwork	~$5–$12 / hr part-time	If you only need 10–20 hrs/week early on. Vetted, reviewable, hire by the hour and scale

Recommendation: start on Upwork part-time (low commitment) while volume is light; move to a dedicated full-time OnlineJobs.ph VA (~$500/mo) once there are enough clients and leads to keep them busy — a full-time VA at $500/mo is dramatically cheaper per hour than Upwork and becomes a reliable owner of the back office.

2.3 Tasks (what they own day to day)

- **Lead research + verification** — run the **Lead-Gen & Verification SOP** end to end: source by trade/city, load every claimed domain, classify NONE/FACEBOOK_ONLY/DEAD/BAD/GOOD, score Priority 5→1, dedupe, and hand the closer a clean call sheet. (Claude can also do this; a VA gives a parallel human channel and keeps the closer's list always full.)
- **CRM upkeep** — keep the pipeline tracker current: log call outcomes, set callbacks, move deals through stages, flag stale leads. The closer just talks; the VA keeps the records straight.
- **Scheduling** — book demo callbacks and go-live calls, manage the calendar, send reminders so no warm lead goes cold.
- **First-line client edit-request intake** — receive incoming “can you change X” requests from Care Plan clients, log them, acknowledge the client, and route to Claude for the actual edit + deploy. The VA is the friendly front desk; Claude does the work.
- **Review & referral follow-ups** — after each go-live, run the follow-up sequence (per the Follow-Up SOP): request a Google review, ask for a referral, check in at 30 days. This compounds into free leads and social proof.

> **The VA is a front desk and a pipeline-keeper, not a builder**
>
> Every task above is either following an existing SOP (lead-gen, follow-up) or simple coordination (CRM, scheduling, intake). The actual skilled work — building and editing sites, deploying, writing copy — stays with Claude/AI. The VA exists so the owner never touches admin and the closer never touches anything but the phone.

2.4 Compensation

- **Full-time OnlineJobs.ph VA:** ~$400–$800/mo (target ~$500/mo) for 40 hrs/week. Flat monthly cost.

- **Part-time Upwork VA:** ~$5–$12/hr, 10–20 hrs/week (~$200–$700/mo depending on load). Pay as you scale.
- **Funding rule:** the VA is a fixed cost, so only hire once recurring + build revenue comfortably covers it (see §4). A VA at $500/mo is paid for by a single build per month — trivial once the closer is producing.
- **Optional micro-bonus:** small spiff (e.g. $5–$10) per verified Google review secured, to keep the review engine hungry.

2.5 The SOPs They Follow (already written)

The VA does not need to be trained from scratch — they are handed the existing playbook library and execute it:

SOP / Playbook	Drives which VA task
Lead-Gen & Verification SOP	Lead research, verification, scoring, dedupe, call-sheet handoff
CRM tracker + README	Pipeline upkeep, stage management, logging
Follow-Up SOP	Post-go-live review requests, referrals, 30-day check-ins
Go-Live SOP	Scheduling go-live, coordinating launch steps
Operations Playbook	Overall process, brand voice, client-facing tone
Onboarding Templates	Client intake + edit-request intake forms/messages

3. The Org Evolution

Four stages, each one funded by the last. The owner's job gets smaller at every stage; the business gets more passive.

3.1 The Four Stages

Stage	Team	What the owner does	What's removed from the own
Stage 0 — Solo	Owner + Claude	Makes the calls, oversees AI. Proves the close	Nothing yet — building+admin already on AI
Stage 1 — +Closer	Owner + Claude + 1 closer	Oversees; jumps on whale deals only	The phones (the big one)
Stage 2 — +VA	Owner + Claude + closer + VA	Light oversight, approvals	Admin, CRM, scheduling, lead-gen, follow-ups
Stage 3 — +2nd closer / content	Owner + Claude + 2 closers + VA (+content)	Strategy & relationships only	Day-to-day entirely — near-passive

3.2 Who Owns What at Each Stage

Stage 0 — Solo (Owner + Claude). Claude builds, edits, deploys, generates and verifies leads, runs the back office. The owner does the one thing AI can't: he gets on the phone and proves the close on the first 3–5 deals. This stage exists to validate the offer and produce a known-good script — nothing more.

Stage 1 — +Closer. The proven script moves to a commission closer. The owner is **off the phones**. He now reviews closer performance, occasionally takes a high-value or referral call, and approves anything non-standard. Claude still owns all building and back office. This is the stage that buys back the owner's voice — the single biggest unlock.

Stage 2 — +VA. A VA takes the admin: lead-gen/verification, CRM, scheduling, edit-request intake, review/referral follow-ups. The owner now does **light oversight and approvals only**. The closer closes, the VA keeps the machine clean, Claude does the skilled work. The owner's daily involvement drops to checking dashboards and signing off.

Stage 3 — +2nd Closer / Content. Add a second closer to double build throughput, and optionally a content/marketing helper to drive inbound leads and Care-Plan retention content. The owner now owns **strategy and key relationships only** — the business runs without his daily presence. This is the near-passive end state: recurring Care-Plan MRR as the floor, closers producing builds, VA keeping it clean, Claude doing the work.

3.3 The Permanent Split: AI vs. Humans

This split never changes as the org grows — it's the structural reason the business stays cheap and scalable. Humans are only ever added for voice and relationship.

STAYS with Claude / AI (forever)	Goes to HUMANS (voice + relationship)
Building the websites	The voice sales call (closer)
All edits + revisions	Holding the client relationship (owner)
Deploys + hosting + uptime	Objection handling / closing the deal (closer)
Lead generation + verification	Friendly front-desk intake (VA)
Demo sites + walkthrough videos	Review/referral asks that need a human touch (VA)
CRM automation, receipts, contracts	Judgment calls + strategy (owner)

The line that defines every future hire

If a task can be done by AI, it stays with AI — we never hire to do something Claude already does well (building, editing, lead-gen, deploys). We hire only to buy back the owner's voice (closer) and the owner's time on coordination (VA). That discipline is what keeps Peak 11 a near-passive, high-margin business instead of a bloated agency.

4. Cost vs. Revenue at Each Stage

The non-negotiable rule: **every hire is funded by revenue the business has already produced.** Because the closer is commission-only and fulfillment is AI, the only true fixed cost in the whole model is the VA. Hiring never gets ahead of revenue.

4.1 The Numbers by Stage

Stage	Monthly cost	How it's funded	Net monthly profit (illustrative)
0 — Solo	~$0 (AI + tools only)	N/A — owner closes 3–5 deals	~$3k–$5k builds
1 — +Closer	Commission only (~15–20% of builds)	Pays itself — cost only exists when a deal closes	~$5k–$8.5k (after commission)
2 — +VA	+ ~$500/mo (VA fixed)	One build/mo covers the VA many times over	~$8k–$12k
3 — +2nd closer (+content)	Commission + ~$500 VA (+opt. content)	2nd closer is commission — self-funding	~$13k–$20k+

Build avg ~$1,050; closer 15–20%; Stripe ~2.9%+$0.30/charge; fulfillment ~$0 (AI). Figures illustrative — actuals depend on close volume.

4.2 Worked Example: One Standard Build

Line	Amount
Standard build ticket	$1,200
Less closer commission (15%)	–$180
Less Stripe fee (~2.9% + $0.30)	–$35
Less fulfillment (AI build/deploy)	–$0
Net to Peak 11 (one-time)	≈ $985
Plus Care Plan started at go-live	+$49/mo recurring (closer takes month 1)

Even after paying the closer generously and Stripe its cut, one Standard build nets ~$985 with effectively zero fulfillment cost. **A single build per month more than funds the entire VA.** Every build also plants a $49/mo Care Plan that compounds (see Management SOP).

4.3 The Funding Rule, Stated Plainly

- **Closers are free until they sell.** Commission-only means you can hire 1 or 2 closers with zero downside — they only cost money out of revenue they themselves created.
- **The VA is the only fixed cost** — and at ~$500/mo it's covered by a single build. Only hire the VA once monthly revenue clears it with room to spare (i.e., after the closer is consistently producing).
- **Care-Plan MRR is the safety floor.** As Care Plans accumulate ($49/mo each, near-zero effort), recurring revenue increasingly covers fixed costs **before a single new build is sold that month** — 20 Care Plans ≈ ~$980/mo, already more than the VA.
- **Never hire ahead of revenue.** The order is fixed: prove the close → add a closer (free) → once builds are flowing, add the VA (cheap, self-funding) → once one closer is maxed, add a second (free). No stage's cost is committed until the prior stage's revenue is real.

Bottom line

Peak 11 reaches near-passive operation with at most one small fixed cost (a ~$500/mo VA) and a couple of commission-only closers who pay for themselves out of every deal. The owner's voice is bought back at Stage 1, his time at Stage 2, and by Stage 3 the business runs on recurring revenue, commission closers, a VA, and Claude — with the owner doing strategy and relationships only. Hiring is always funded by revenue already proven, never on faith.
